

Nicholas Hall

Senior Platform Engineer / Staff SRE / DevOps Lead

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SUMMARY

Platform, Site Reliability, and DevOps engineer with 21 years of experience building production systems across defense, broadcast, streaming, robotics, AI, finance, cloud, on-prem, and edge environments. Builds the platform layer that lets engineering teams move faster without making production fragile: Kubernetes delivery systems, GitOps workflows, observability platforms, compliance controls, incident response, and automation that turns repeated operational work into reusable infrastructure.

SELECTED IMPACT

- Reduced CI/CD build time from 60 minutes to 6 by moving deployments to GitOps with ArgoCD and Helm and coordinating the rollout across engineering, product, and customer success.
- Owned SOC2 Type 2 end to end as primary responsible engineer, defining controls, implementing technical enforcement, and carrying the audit through completion; passed audit execution in 4 hours against an expected 3-day window.
- Cut \$4M/year in GCP spend for Paramount+ by reducing BigQuery dependence and deduplicating log messages at the source without degrading observability.
- Operated observability at streaming scale, running Elasticsearch on Kubernetes with ECK for a platform processing 20 billion log entries per week.
- Migrated services to Kubernetes and improved deployment/recovery time by 83% while improving RTO by 87%; built 25 Helm charts that reduced new tenant setup from one week to 30 minutes.
- Helped build and launch Graylog Cloud, an AWS-based SaaS product that later grew to \$20M ARR, carrying the platform through SOC2, beta, and general availability.

EXPERIENCE

Growth Protocol - Senior DevOps Engineer

May 2025 - Apr 2026

- Owned SOC2 Type 2 end to end as the primary responsible engineer: defined the control set, implemented technical enforcement, and carried the audit to completion.
- Executed and passed SOC2 compliance audits in 4 hours against an anticipated 3-day audit window.
- Moved deployments to GitOps with ArgoCD and Helm, reducing CI/CD build times from 60 minutes to 6 while coordinating the change across engineering, product, and customer success.
- Ran multi-cloud Kubernetes across GKE, AKS, and EKS, consolidating 30+ Cloud Run microservices onto one consistent, fully deployable platform.
- Optimized ML training on Elasticsearch, reducing training time from days to hours and compute cost from hundreds of dollars to tens per run.

Lunar Lanes - Owner and Lead Engineer (concurrent)

Dec 2024 - Present

- Own and operate a business end to end, from engineering and automation through daily operations, reliability, customer experience, and P&L.
- Took the business from unimproved land to operational in 90 days, making architecture, reliability, cost, and operational tradeoffs against real business outcomes.
- Built an event-driven IoT and observability stack for legacy electromechanical equipment using ESP32 edge nodes, ESPNow, RS485 fallback, per-lane compute, MQTT, and structured versioned sensor events.
- Shipped a React and TypeScript operations dashboard with live machine telemetry; deployed an AI phone agent for reservations and lane availability, integrated into the operating platform.

Formant - Senior DevOps Engineer

Mar 2024 - Apr 2025

- Built the telemetry-to-training pipeline for industrial robot fleets, collecting operational data from robots and feeding it into models for predictive maintenance and fleet health.
- Migrated platform services off EC2 and Docker Compose onto Kubernetes, converting deployments to Helm charts for repeatable releases and rollbacks.
- Built CI/CD pipelines, observability, and on-call coverage, reducing operational toil and clearing standing technical debt.

FORT Robotics - Site Reliability Engineer

Aug 2022 - Mar 2024

- Owned incident response for Fort Manager, a greenfield robotics-safety SaaS platform, authoring disaster recovery plans, on-call procedures, and the runbooks engineers worked from.
- Migrated services to Kubernetes, reducing deployment and recovery time by 83% and improving RTO by 87%.
- Built the observability and metrics platform used across the team for operational health, capacity planning, cost visibility, and production debugging.
- Built 25 Helm charts that reduced new tenant setup from one week to 30 minutes.

Paramount+ / Paramount Global - Site Reliability Engineer (Contract)

Jan 2022 - Aug 2022

- Ran logging and observability for a streaming platform at scale, operating an Elasticsearch cluster on Kubernetes with ECK that processed 20 billion log entries per week.
- Made the cost-versus-reliability call that cut \$4M/year in GCP spend, reducing BigQuery dependence and deduplicating log messages at the source without degrading observability.
- Moved logging deployments to GitOps with ArgoCD and built a reusable regex library that structured billions of previously unstructured log entries and made production signal usable across teams.

Graylog - Senior Site Reliability Engineer

Jan 2020 - Dec 2021

Helped build and launch Graylog Cloud, the company's AWS-based SaaS offering that later grew to \$20M ARR, contributing to the platform foundations that carried it through SOC2, beta, and general availability.

Built a Go load-testing platform generating 200,000 logging requests per second to validate platform performance under production-scale ingest load.

Supported the reliability, automation, and operational foundations required to turn a logging product into a production SaaS platform.

United Community Bank - DevOps Engineer

Oct 2019 - Dec 2019

Built a web-based Ansible front end using Python, Flask, and Celery to automate Linux patch management; managed on-prem Kubernetes and Terraform-based infrastructure as code.

KSDK-TV / NBC - IT Manager

May 2016 - Apr 2019

Led an IT team building Python and PowerShell automation that reduced rework by 97% and saved 160 hours annually on routine tasks.

Earlier Roles: Maryville University, Enterprise Holdings, Computer Techniques | 2011 - 2016

SKILLS

Platform / Infrastructure: Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Terraform, Ansible, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Linux, on-prem, edge, distributed systems

Cloud: AWS, GCP, Azure, GKE, AKS, EKS, Cloud Run, BigQuery

Observability / Reliability: Elasticsearch, ECK, OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Grafana, logging, metrics, alerting, incident response, disaster recovery, RTO/RPO, on-call systems

Data / Messaging: Kafka, MQTT, Redis, Postgres, MongoDB, Snowflake, structured event schemas

Security / Compliance: SOC2 Type 2, control implementation, audit readiness, technical enforcement, secrets management, IAM

Software / Automation: Python, Go, Bash, PowerShell, TypeScript, React, Flask, Celery, APIs, automation tooling